

US Media & Telecom

Fox-Roku: Strategic Fit at a Strategic Price

Laurent Yoon
+1 917 344 8502
laurent.yoon@bernsteinsg.com



Martin Boruchowicz
+1 917 344 8564
martin.boruchowicz@bernsteinsg.com



Andrew Chung
+1 917 344 8302
andrew.chung@bernsteinsg.com

Valuation aside, we have little doubt that **ROKU is an attractive—interesting at minimum—strategic asset for many players in Media**. It offers a growing FAST platform, meaningful adtech capabilities, and, most importantly, significant distribution reach with 1st party data. This combination pushes media companies in transition to consider whether a tie-up could accelerate, or at least support, their shift toward a streaming future.

Strategic assets are never cheap. In fact, “strategic” often translates to “expensive.” While we agree with Fox’s strategic rationale (there it is again), we question whether Fox needs to own ROKU to achieve similar outcomes—a commercial partnership could potentially deliver comparable benefits. That said, we believe the **acquisition helps clarify FOXA’s long-term intent**. While it may create near-term pressure, it effectively buys time for FOXA to demonstrate its transition to streaming—one where TGR is no longer a negative value.

Five key takeaways for us:

Deal structure, leverage, and EPS. FOXA plans to acquire ROKU in a 60/40 cash-and-stock transaction, resulting in a still-healthy 2.9x net leverage at close. We expect EPS dilution of ~10% in 2028, pre-synergies.

Valuation. The \$22B price tag implies ~30x NTM EBITDA and ~60x NTM EPS (based on street consensus, which may prove conservative relative to buy-side expectations). While richly valued, strategic assets rarely come cheap—and ROKU is a unique asset for FOXA.

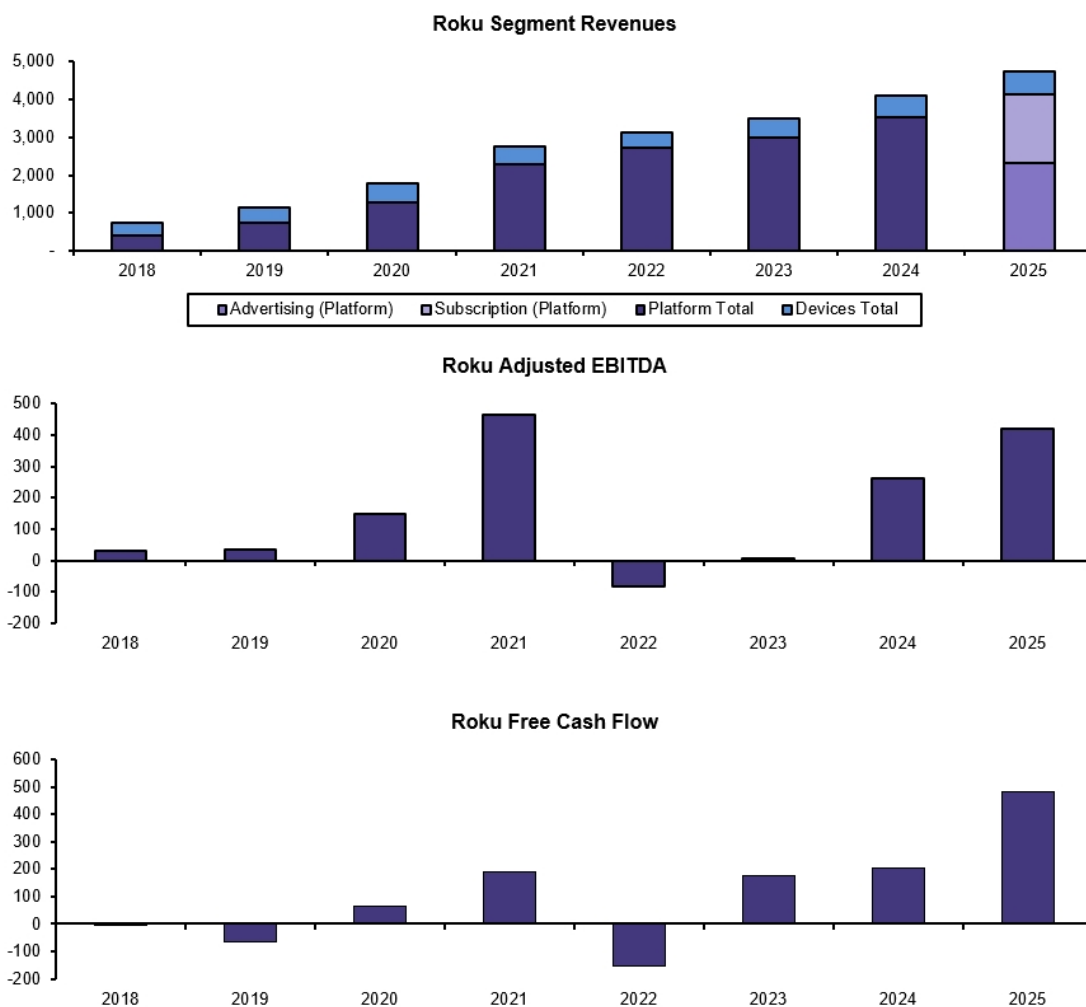
Regulatory process. Both companies are subscale in streaming today, and the combined entity would continue to face substantial competition across streaming and O/S (e.g., Android, Tizen, webOS, etc). We do not anticipate significant regulatory hurdles.

Strategic rationale. Could ROKU accelerate/extend digital subscription growth for FOXA’s properties? Probably. Does FOXA need to own ROKU to achieve this? Probably not—commercial partnerships could prove suffice. However, the advertising opportunity is more intriguing. FOXA has onboarded more than 500 new advertisers over the past couple of years, driving strong demand for its inventory and higher CPMs. With that momentum, FOXA could better monetize ROKU’s ad inventory through higher fill-rates and pricing. If FOXA can demonstrate sustained traction in both subscription and advertising growth in streaming—offsetting concerns about the longer-term durability of its linear business—its multiple could re-rate. Perhaps a bit early to be too optimistic.

Who else may enter the race. [Several names](#) have been floated over the years, but most are not worth serious consideration in our view. The key question is: who could benefit from ROKU’s reach and/or could better monetize ROKU’s ad inventory? The list is short, and even shorter at \$160/share floor. We’d be disappointed to see a competing bid emerge.

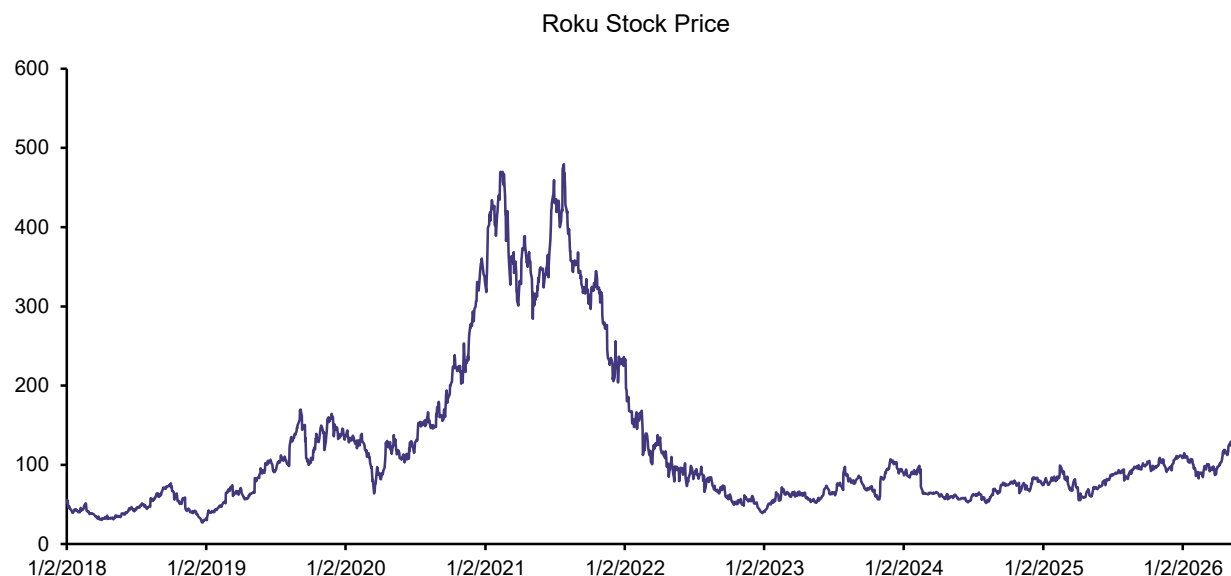
EXHIBIT 1: After a COVID-era profitability spike and a 2022 reset, Roku's steadily rising Platform revenue has led to improving EBITDA and FCF...

In Millions



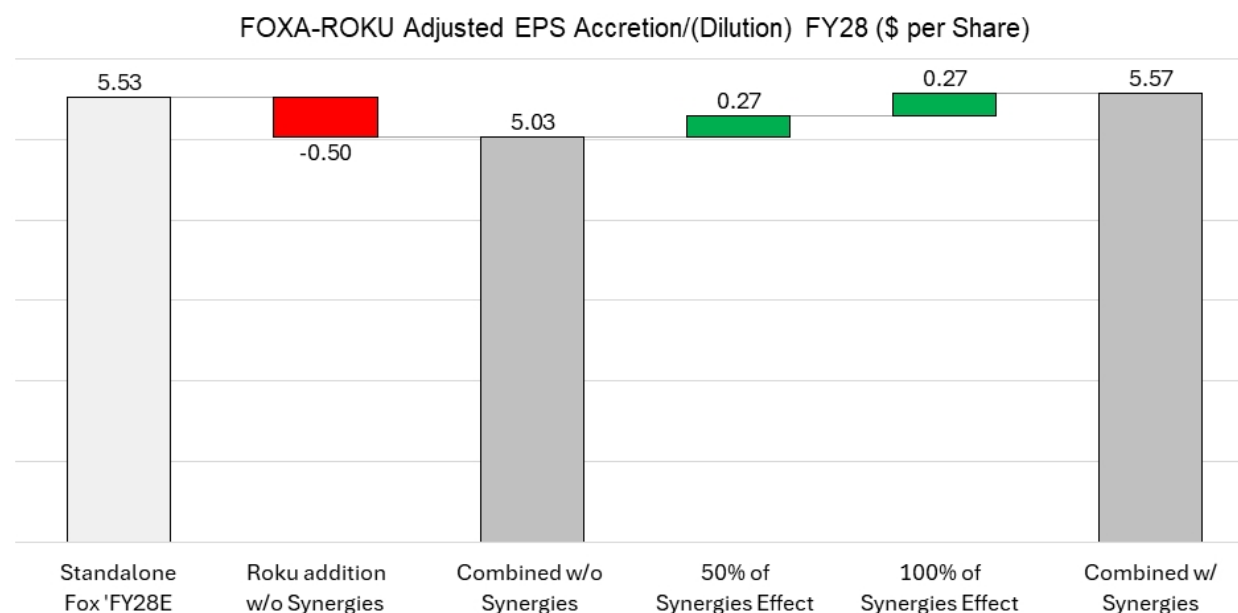
Source: Roku Filings, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 2: ...accordingly, ROKU's stock price has also risen after Covid reset



Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 3: The Roku transaction appears to be dilutive (aprox. 10%) to EPS ex. synergies

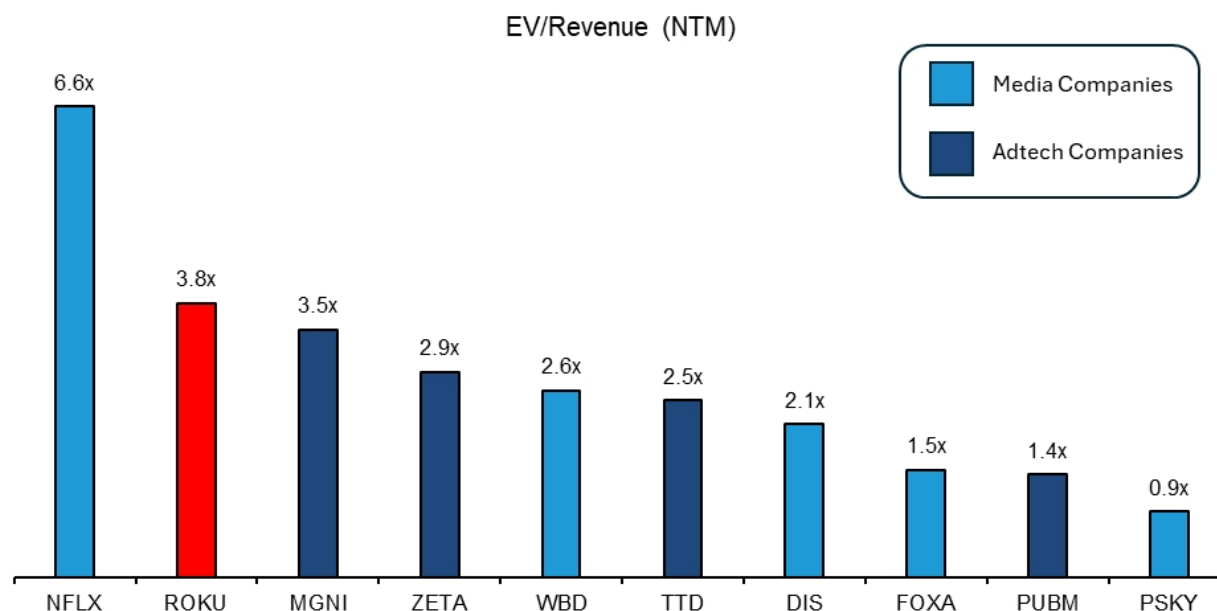


Assumes a 5% cost of debt for new debt issued to finance the transaction.

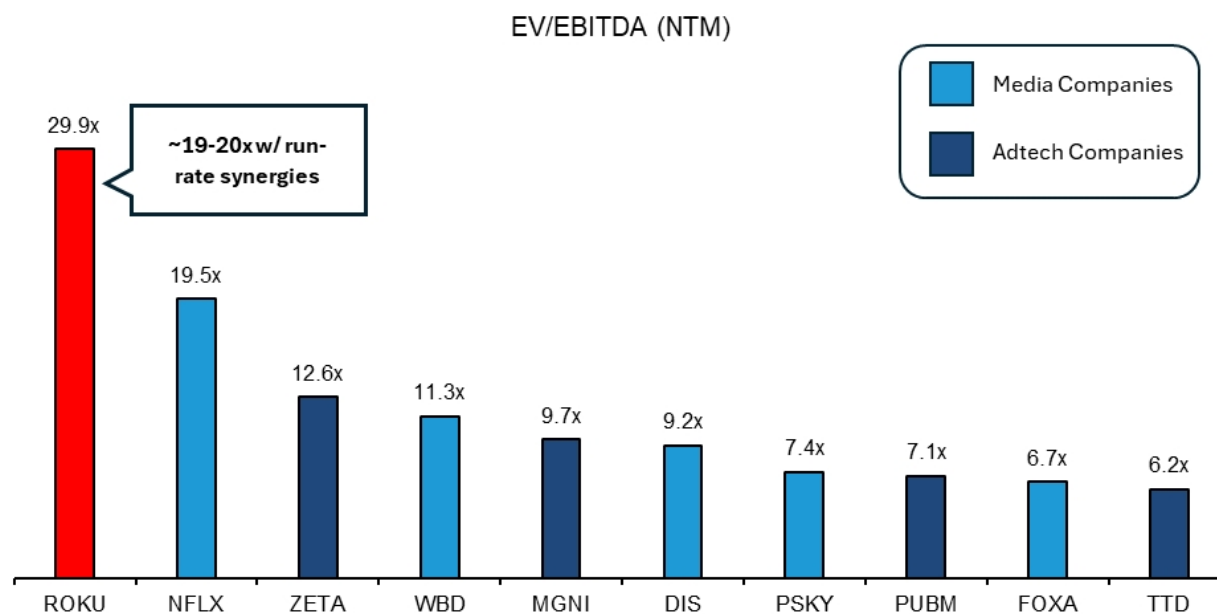
Based on FOXA's FY27 (CY 2H27-1H28).

Based on Bloomberg consensus estimates.

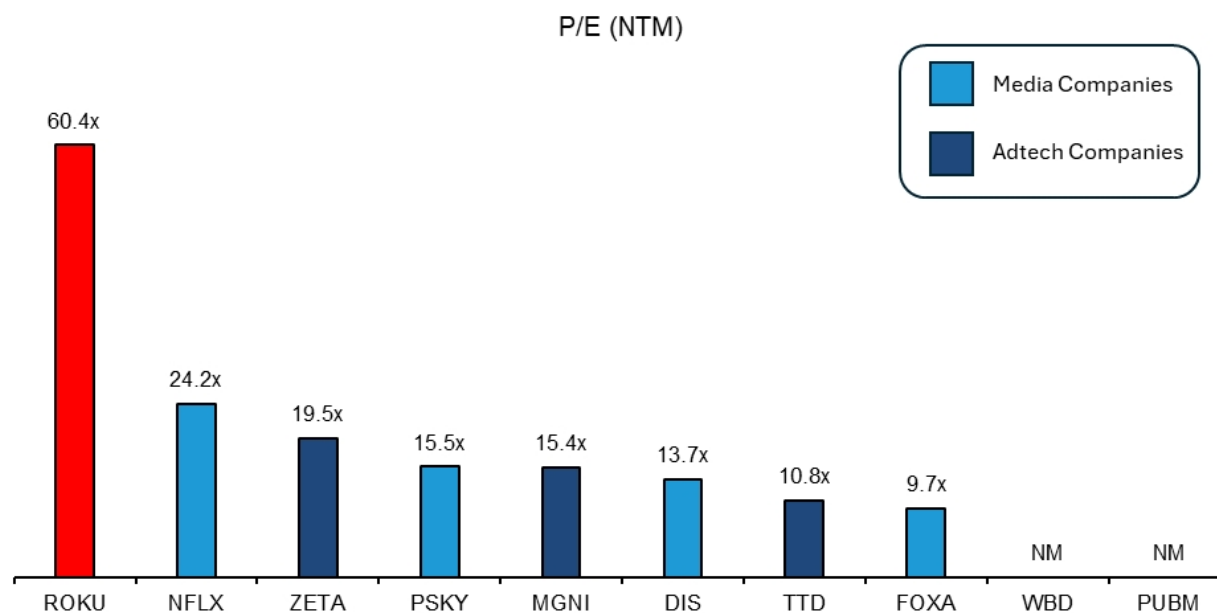
Source: Company filings, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates & analysis

EXHIBIT 4: **The Roku acquisition price is in the high end of valuation comps - EV/Rev**

Source: Company filings, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates & analysis

EXHIBIT 5: **The Roku acquisition price is in the high end of valuation comps - EV/EBITDA**

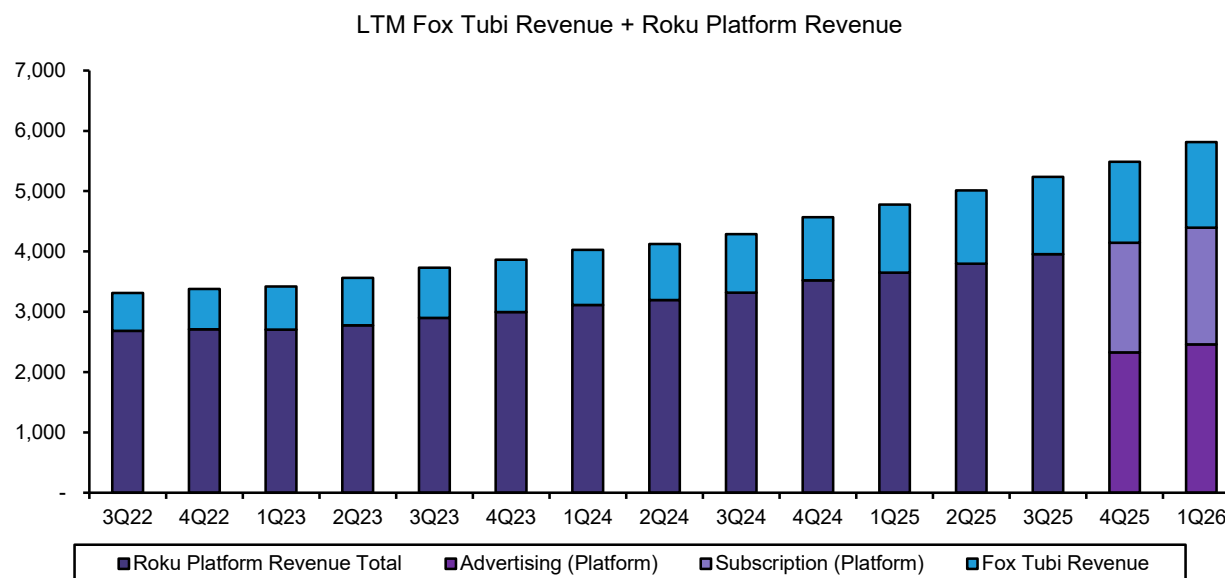
Source: Company filings, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates & analysis

EXHIBIT 6: **The Roku acquisition price is in the high end valuation comps - P/E**

Source: Company filings, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates & analysis

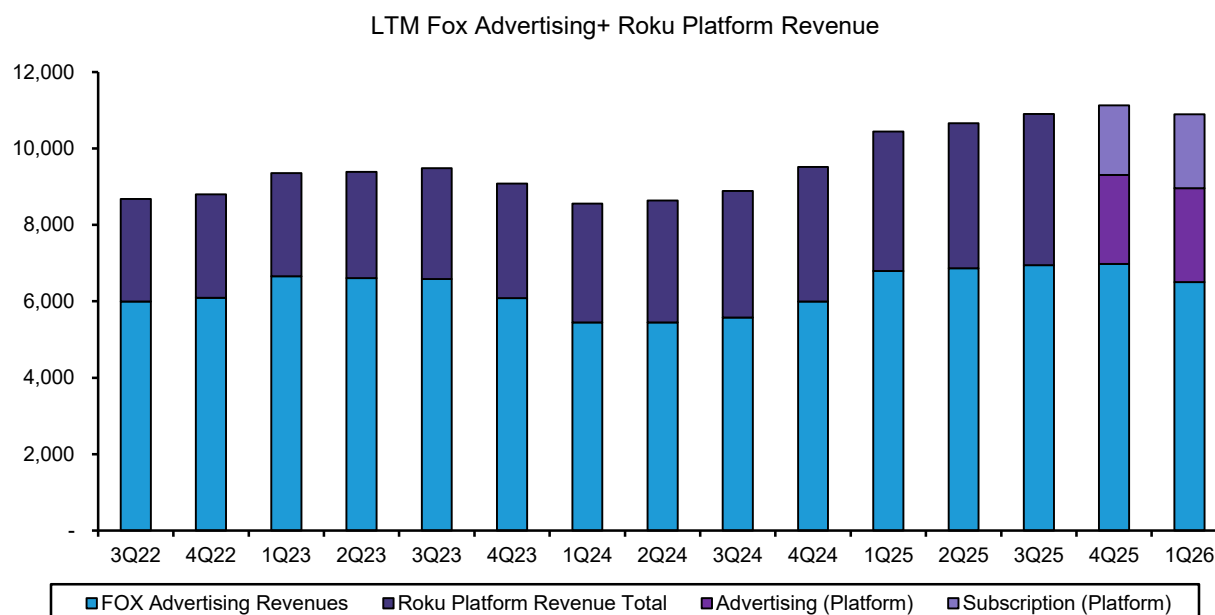
EXHIBIT 7: **LTM Fox's digital revenue through Tubi and Roku's Platform Revenues combined have been experiencing over 20% growth YoY Growth in recent quarters**

In Millions



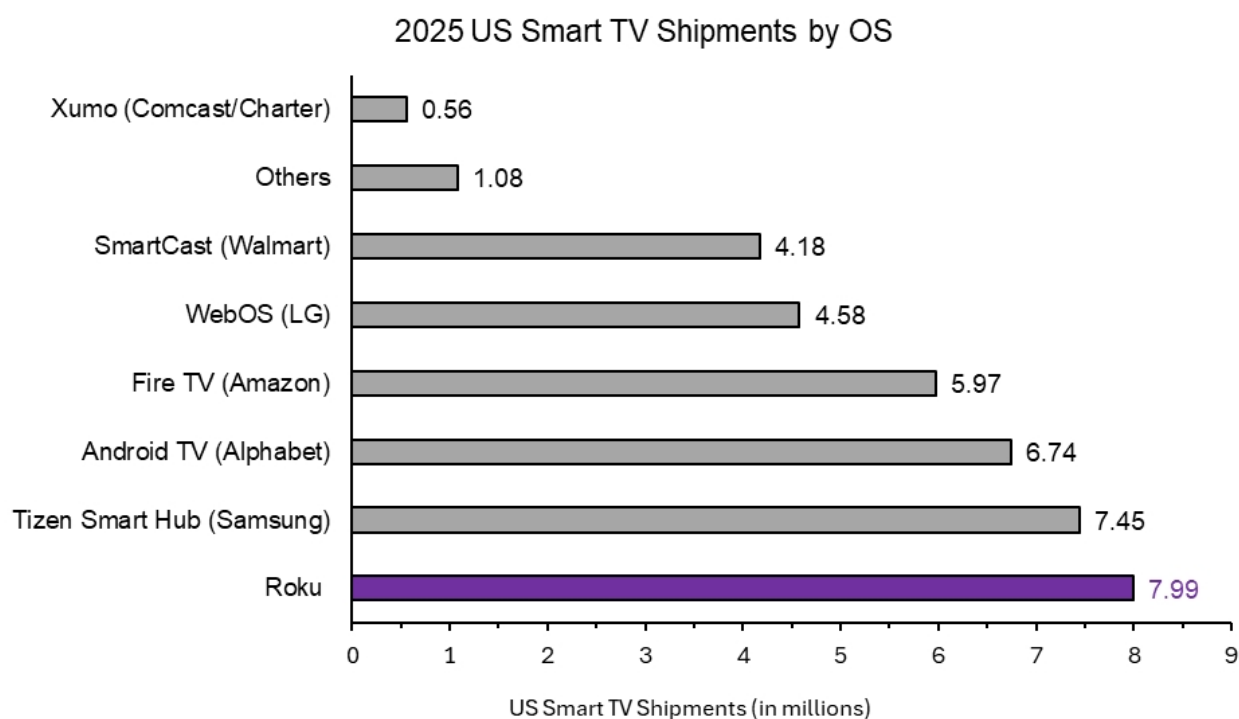
Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 8: **Advertising is a key expected revenue synergy, as Fox's strong advertiser relationships and demand can be combined with Roku's scaled CTV inventory and 1P data to drive higher pricing and monetization.**



Source: Company reports, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 9: **Exhibit 9 - Roku's OS had the largest US market share, but there are many competing platforms**



Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence; Bernstein analysis

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We maintain our Outperform rating for NFLX (PT: \$110) and DIS (PT: \$129); Market-Perform rating for FOX (PT: \$73), WBD (PT: \$27.75), and CMCSA (MP: \$32); and Underperform rating for PSKY (PT: \$12) - all unchanged.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

15 Jun 2026						TTM	Adjusted EPS			Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing	Price	Rel.							
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
NFLX (Netflix)	O	USD	81.67	110.00	(59.0)%	USD	2.53	3.20	3.80	32.3	25.5	21.5
FOXA (Fox)	M	USD	54.76	73.00	(24.4)%	USD	4.47	5.16	5.81	12.2	10.6	9.4
CMCSA (Comcast)	M	USD	23.97	32.00	(53.3)%	USD	4.30	3.34	3.90	5.6	7.2	6.1
PSKY (Paramount Skydance)	U	USD	10.49	12.00	NA	USD	0.52	0.66	0.60	20.2	15.9	17.5
DIS (Disney)	O	USD	101.69	129.00	(40.2)%	USD	5.93	6.85	7.37	17.1	14.8	13.8
WBD (Warner Bros)	M	USD	26.83	27.75	141.1%	USD	0.29	(1.23)	(0.32)	92.5	(21.9)	(84.8)
SPX			7,554.29									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**Netflix Inc**

We value NFLX's shares at an implied 29x multiple (rounded) on FY27 EPS estimates of \$3.80 (PT of \$110). Two key assumptions are '27E EPS of \$3.80 and 29x (rounded) EPS multiple.

Fox Corp

We value Fox on a discounted cash flow basis and reference terminal value assumptions using current trading multiples. The two key assumptions in the model are (1) terminal value of \$21B, and (2) WACC of 7%. Our Price Target is \$73.

Comcast Corp

Our price target of \$32 for Comcast is based on DCF and reference terminal value assumptions using current trading multiples. The two key assumptions in the model are (1) WACC of 10% and (2) terminal growth rate of -1.5%.

Paramount Skydance

We value Paramount at \$12 on a discounted cash flow basis and reference terminal value assumptions using current trading multiples. The two key assumptions in the model are (1) terminal value of \$22B (nominal), and (2) WACC of 9%.

Walt Disney Co

Our price target of \$129 for Walt Disney is based on a discounted cash flow basis and reference terminal value assumptions using current trading multiples. The two key assumptions in the model are (1) terminal value of \$300B, and (2) WACC of 9%.

Warner Bros Discovery Inc

Given the active process, we're using NFLX's bid of \$27.75/sh as floor price as our PT.

RISKS**Netflix Inc**

Downside risks: - AVOD does not lift ARM in UCAN as much as expected. Digital advertising may not recover as quickly or as strongly as we modeled which could lead to lower ARM, particularly in UCAN. Netflix could lose subscribers as streaming gets increasingly competitive. Streaming is getting increasingly competitive with big tech investing more in the space. Competition from social platforms with user generated content. Short form videos are taking users eyeballs, which could have a long term impact on engagement.

Fox Corp

Upside Risks to our Price Target: The Legacy business may be more resilient than we have expected, or the company manages to find another way to monetize its content outside Pay-TV ecosystem effectively. Tubi may turn profitable faster than expected

and achieve a much higher margin.

Downside Risks to our Price Target: Cord-cutting may accelerate; FAST competition can intensify; and Tubi may never turn profitable.

Comcast Corp

Upside risks to our price target include: (1) FWA and Fiber deployment slow down, leading to more subs for Comcast; (2) Wireless ARPU could grow faster, increasing EBITDA; and (3) Peacock margins could turn positive earlier and expand faster.

Downside risks to our CMCSA price target include: the competitive pricing environment could be more aggressive than we expect. Longer term, broadband regulation could become more onerous. 5G and fixed wireless could continue to take broadband customers sooner and/or to greater degrees than we expect. NBCU, like other media businesses, is under pressure from streaming services and performance could deteriorate relative to expectations.

Paramount Skydance

Upside risks to our price target: (1) Paramount's DTC may grow faster than anticipated driven by international subscribers; (2) increase ARPU faster driven by more aggressive pricing actions and/or improving ad monetization; and/or (3) Linear decline may decelerate as the market reaches its core base of PayTV subscribers.

Walt Disney Co

Downside Risks to our Price Target: (1) Cord-cutting may accelerate even faster than anticipated; (2) ESPN bundling may not result in significant churn reduction; (3) Disney+ and Hulu subscriber growth could slow meaningfully driven by competition; and (4) macroeconomic event may lead to significant drop in Parks attendance and/or spending.

Warner Bros Discovery Inc

Upside risks to our Price Target: WBD's legacy business could perform better than expected as it deploys content capital more efficiently than current expectations; DTC could see substantial success in international expansion; and a potential bidding war for the assets, or the expectations thereof, could drive up the stock further.

Downside risks to our Price Target: WBD's legacy business, which currently supports its entire current FCF is in structural decline. It's also the source of funds for growing DTC. 1) WBD may fail to service its debt due to cord cutting accelerating and cable-bundle breaking, 2) WBD's DTC growth stalls if it is not able to invest in quality content leading to higher churn rate, inability to raise prices or expand internationally, and 3) Studios business recovery could slow down

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION

EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS

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The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIA) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

The Bernstein brand has three categories of ratings:

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- Market-Perform: Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/- 15 pp
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Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – common stocks

The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 500 Banks And Financial Services Index (BEBANKS) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 500 Insurance Index (BEINSUR) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, and the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

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Those denoted as 'Feature' (e.g., Feature Outperform FOP, Feature Under Outperform FUP) are our core ideas.

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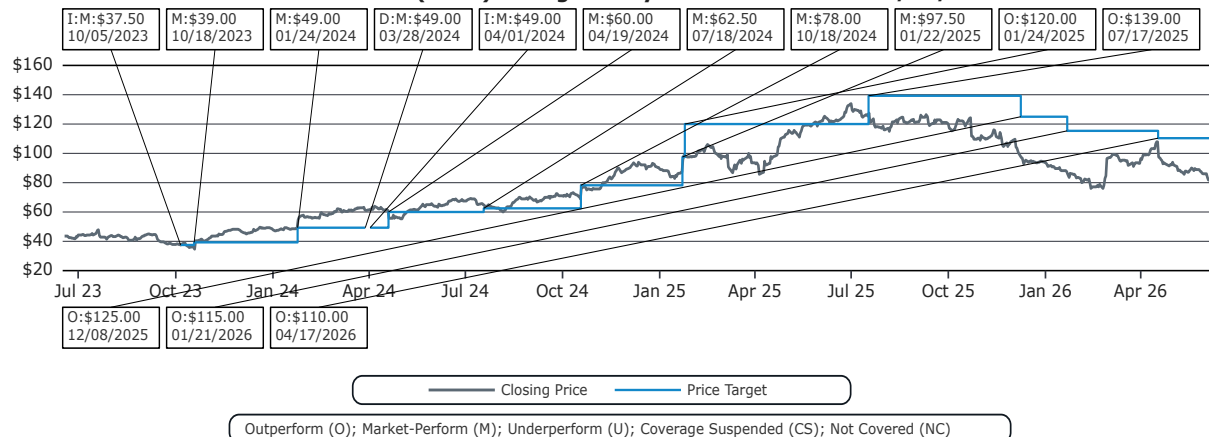
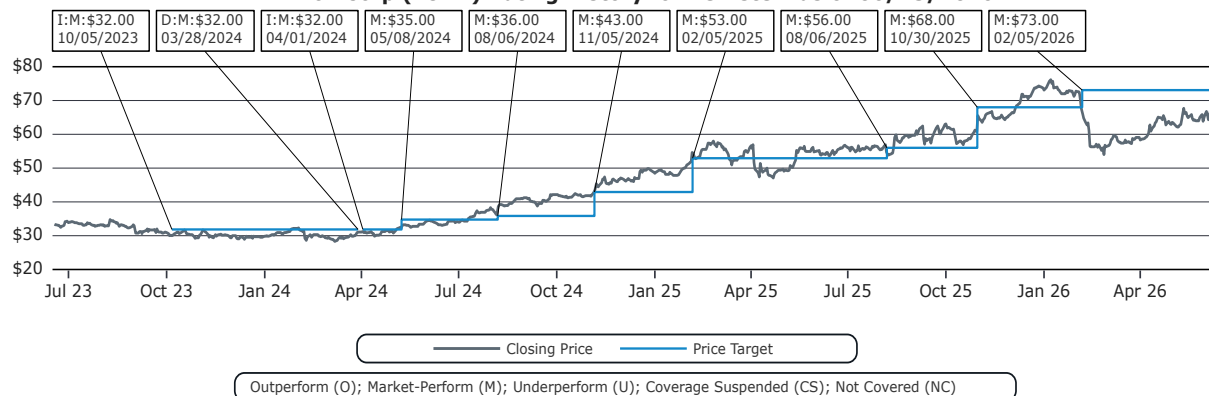
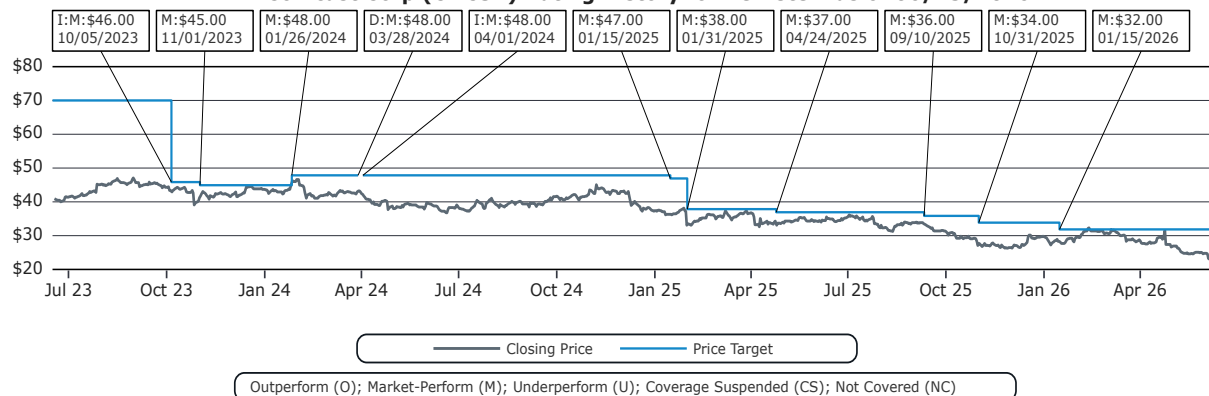
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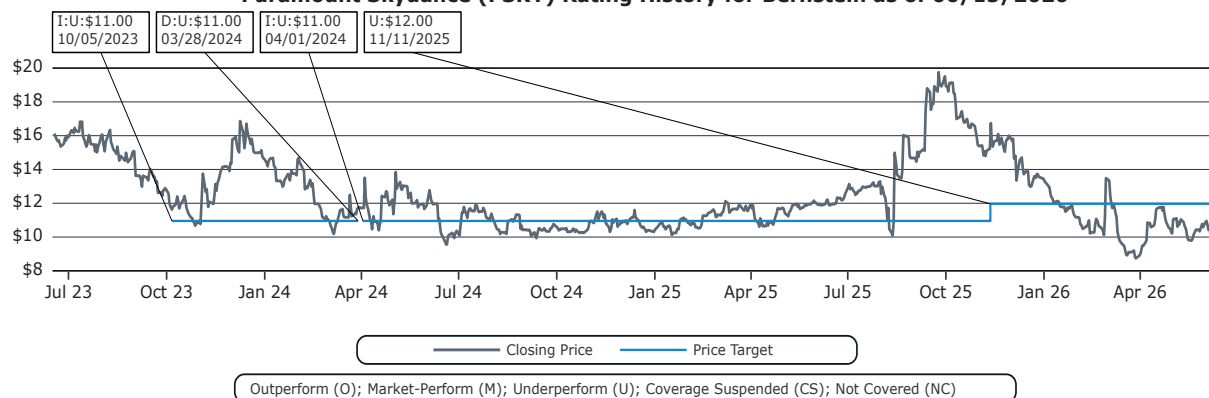
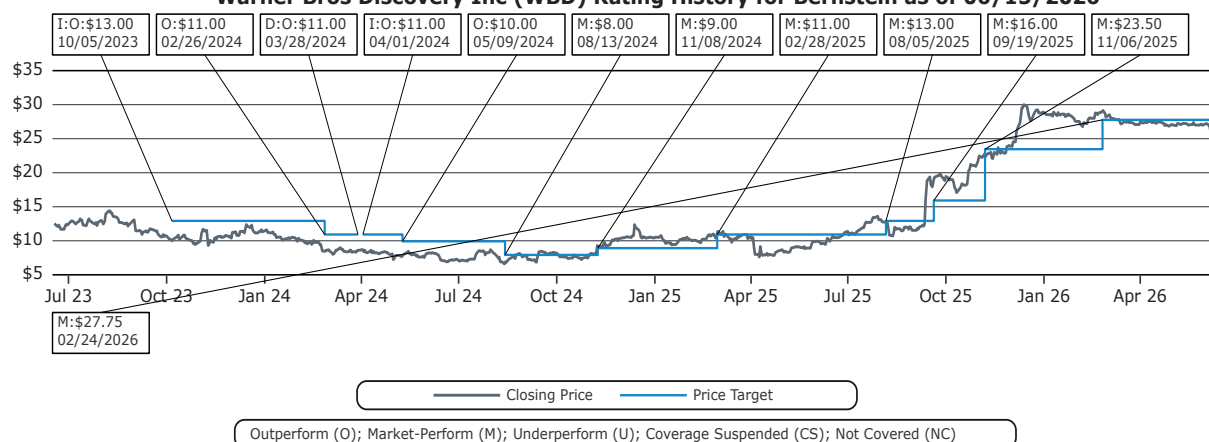
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Outperform	BUY	51.1%	16.5%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	36.3%	17.8%
Underperform	SELL	12.6%	14.9%

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Netflix Inc (NFLX) Rating History for Bernstein as of 06/15/2026**Fox Corp (FOXA) Rating History for Bernstein as of 06/15/2026****Comcast Corp (CMCSA) Rating History for Bernstein as of 06/15/2026**

Paramount Skydance (PSKY) Rating History for Bernstein as of 06/15/2026**Walt Disney Co (DIS) Rating History for Bernstein as of 06/15/2026****Warner Bros Discovery Inc (WBD) Rating History for Bernstein as of 06/15/2026**

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